

Page 1

- **penchant** – formal: liking, preference; tendency
- **knack** – informal: skill, ability
- **humbled** – made to feel less important
- **bestow** – formal: give
- **rising tides of** – increases in
- **amidst** – literary: in the middle of
- **in the midst of** – formal: in the middle of
- **far-reaching** – having a great effect
- **shutter** – AmE: close (a business)
- **span of time** – period of time
- **recriminations** – criticizing someone who has criticized you
- **dogma** – belief, principle
- **strangle** – *here*: stop something developing
- **reaffirm** – state something again
- **enduring** – lasting
- **settle for** – accept
- **faint-hearted** – not brave
- **doer** – an active person who achieves things
- **rugged** – literary: difficult
- **toil** – literary: work hard
- **time and again** – often, repeatedly
- **raw** – very sore, painful
- **undiminished** – not reduced
- **stand pat** – AmE: remain unchanged
- **wield** – use
- **harness** – control and make use of
- **peril** – literary: danger, risk
- **draft** – write
- **expedience** – formal: doing what is easy rather than morally right
- **sturdy** – strong
- **emanate from** – formal: come from
- **justness** – fairness
- **cause** – *here*: aim, principle
- **temper** – formal: make milder, less extreme
- **humility** – behaving in a humble way
- **legacy** – something that exists as a result of a past event/action
- **forge** – develop, create
- **foe** – literary: enemy
- **roll back** – AmE: reduce

Page 2

- **waver** – hesitate, weaken

- **patchwork** – something made up of many different parts
- **swill** – liquid waste
- **deceit** – dishonesty, tricking people
- **dissent** – strong disagreement with general opinion
- **pledge** – promise
- **without regard to** – without considering
- **embody** – be a symbol of
- **determination** – pursuing a goal without giving up
- **rely upon** – need
- **levee** – a wall built to stop a river flooding
- **nurture** – take care of
- **grudgingly** – not willingly
- **creed** – formal: a set of beliefs
- **virtue** – good personal qualities
- **hardship** – pain, suffering
- **rationalism** – the belief in reason and logic
- **preceding** – previous, (the one) before
- **based on** – practical experience and experiments (*refers to empiricism line*)
- **horrendous** – terrible
- **fulfilment** – feeling of happiness and satisfaction
- **burgeoning** – growing, flourishing
- **renowned** – famous
- **pamphlet** – very thin book, brochure
- **vast** – very large
- **visage** – literary: face, facial expression
- **frown** – moving together of the eyebrows to show worry, irritation or concentration
- **sneer** – facial expression showing disrespect
- **wreck** – something badly damaged or destroyed
- **boundless** – without an end

Page 3

- **unobjectionable** – inoffensive, agreeable
- **pending** – formal: until, awaiting
- **rig** – equipment
- **megalomaniacal** – having a strong desire for power and control
- **sprout** – produce, grow
- **wondrous** – literary: exciting, marvellous
- **husbandry** – farming
- **steer** – young male cow raised for beef
- **derive** – get, obtain
- **fabricate** – construct, produce
- **jettison** – throw away
- **envision** – imagine
- **enrich** – make better by adding something
- **palatability** – how pleasant something tastes
- **victuals** – dated: food

- **balk at** – refuse to do something
- **muse** – say thoughtfully
- **edible** – can be eaten
- **palatable** – pleasant to taste
- **constituent** – part, component
- **ominous** – indicating that something bad might happen
- **patty** – flat, round piece of minced food
- **ill advised** – not sensible or wise
- **cache** – a (hidden) store of things
- **seal** – shut, close (up)
- **shielding** – protection
- **crow** – say with pride or triumph
- **batch** – an amount of something
- **justification** – explanation, excuse

Page 4

- **jarring** – upsetting, disturbing
- **tedious** – boring (for too long)
- **stasis** – a period/state of inactivity, when nothing changes
- **hugely** – very much, widely
- **replicate** – *here*: copy, reproduce
- **obtain** – get, achieve
- **sleep deprived** – suffering from a lack of sleep
- **kin** – one's family and relations
- **induce** – cause something to happen
- **retain** – keep
- **dissect** – *here*: analyse in detail
- **quaver** – shake slightly
- **momentary** – lasting a very short time
- **phlegm** – mucus; slimy liquid in your nose and throat
- **disobey** – refuse to follow instructions, defy
- **stiff** – *here*: high, steep
- **tangle** – untidy/confused mass, jumble
- **snaking** – twisting and turning
- **humming** – making a low continuous droning/whirring sound
- **flicker** – shine unsteadily, twinkle
- **parchment** – early form of paper made from animal skin
- **on the instant** – archaic: instantly, immediately
- **to the letter** – exactly
- **char** – partially burned material
- **custom** – *here*: tradition, norm
- **flush** – blush, go red (in the face)
- **twitch** – make a sudden short movement
- **roaring** – *here*: burning very brightly
- **sway** – move slowly and rhythmically from side to side
- **padded** – covered, filled

- **spinal column** – backbone

Page 5

- **murmur** – low continuous background noise
- **wilderness** – wild uninhabited area
- **fern** – flowerless plant with leaves shaped like feathers
- **tar** – asphalt
- **finicky** – requiring or showing great attention to detail
- **roach** – type of freshwater fish; OR informal: cockroach
- **annihilate** – destroy
- **snort** – make a short grunting sound to show disgust, surprise etc.
- **vulture** – large bird that eats dead animals
- **boil down to** – be the main reason for something
- **boar** – wild pig
- **expendable** – disposable, of little importance
- **loins** – literary: sexual organs
- **slay** – literary: kill in a violent way
- **throttle** – choke, strangle
- **womb** – organ in a female body where a baby grows before birth
- **wax** – literary: grow, become larger
- **teeming** – crowded, full
- **far-flung** – widespread; far away
- **rustle** – soft dry sound made by moving leaves, paper etc.
- **correlate** – formal: establish a connection between two things; coordinate
- **palely** – weakly
- **soar** – fly high in the air
- **cavernous** – giving an impression of vast dark depths
- **delirium** – fever, hallucination
- **stride** – walk with long confident steps
- **sheathed over** – covered, encased
- **mesh** – interlaced structure like a net
- **coil** – curl, twist
- **pelvic** – related to the pelvis; lumbar
- **poised** – composed, graceful
- **warily** – carefully, cautiously
- **jerk** – make a quick, sharp, sudden movement
- **cap gun** – toy pistol
- **crusted** – having a hard outer layer
- **undulate** – literary: move gently up and down like waves on the sea
- **numb** – unable to feel anything
- **shuffle** – walk without lifting your feet
- **lunge** – move forward with a sudden thrust of the body
- **engulf** – sweep over, cover
- **stench** – very bad smell
- **lever** – bar or handle used to control a machine etc.
- **lash** – strike sharply

- **boulder-stone** – large smooth rock
- **wrench** – pull hard, yank
- **fount** – literary: fountain, spring
- **sac** – part of an animal or plant that is like a bag and filled with liquid or air
- **gush** – flood, spurt
- **drench** – soak, wet thoroughly
- **glistening** – shining, sparkling (something wet)
- **gauze** – thin transparent fabric
- **spleen** – abdominal organ that produces and cleans the body's blood
- **locomotive** – railway engine
- **steam shovel** – a digger powered by steam

Page 6

- **valve** – tap, regulator
- **tonnage** – very heavy weight
- **mooring** – place where something is fixed or tied
- **wearily** – in a tired way
- **stagnating** – *here*: rotting, deteriorating
- **mound** – pile
- **fumble** – move your hands around clumsily
- **tremoring** – shaking
- **nudge** – push or touch gently, prod
- **taint** – stain, defect
- **subliminal** – subconscious
- **clod** – lump
- **embedded** – fixed/set in a surrounding mass
- **exquisite** – very beautiful and delicate
- **weakling** – weak person
- **scrabble** – fumble, feel around
- **plead** – beg, ask desperately
- **beefcake** – informal: attractive man with large muscles
- **blond** – with fair/light hair (male)
- **grieve** – mourn, feel very sad because someone has died
- **enable** – allow, permit
- **retailer** – person/company that sells goods directly to the public
- **supply chain** – the processes involved in supplying a product to the buyer
- **percolate** – formal: spread slowly
- **insatiable** – limitless, cannot be satisfied
- **discarded** – rejected, thrown away
- **estimated** – guessed, reckoned
- **paradigm shift** – formal: a major change in ideas, methods, approach etc.
- **garment** – item of clothing
- **fad** – short-lived trend
- **predicated** – formal: based, established
- **pipe dream** – wish that is very unlikely to come true
- **deliberation** – discussion, debate; consideration

- **imply** – suggest, indicate
- **attainable** – possible, achievable
- **elicit** – formal: manage to get a certain reaction/information from someone
- **reliant** – dependent
- **aspiration** – ambition, goal
- **hedonistic** – self-indulgent, pleasure-seeking
- **turn a blind eye** – ignore, pretend not to see
- **radical** – drastic, extreme
- **streak** – part of someone's character, trait
- **inherent** – basic, integral, innate
- **go through the roof** – informal: rise to a very high level

Page 7

- **commodity** – something basic to be bought and sold
- **soluble** – able to be dissolved (in water, fat/oils etc.)
- **day of reckoning** – *here*: judgement day, turning point
- **fickle** – always changing your mind about who/what you like
- **thatch** – straw or reeds used to make roofs
- **disguise oneself (as)** – modify one's appearance
- **sorcerer** – (evil) person with magical powers
- **shed** – (shed, shed) lose/drop something in a natural way or by accident
- **leap** – (leapt, leapt) *here*: jump over
- **turnstile** – narrow gate with metal bars that you push round to enter an area
- **tiara** – piece of jewellery like a small crown worn by women at very formal occasions
- **fuzzy** – tightly curled
- **ensemble** – set of clothes, outfit
- **desirable** – wanted, desired
- **heir** – someone who will receive money, property, a title or a duty when another person dies
- **foresee** – (foresaw, foreseen) predict, expect
- **varnish** – liquid that gives a shiny protective surface
- **railing** – fence made from metal bars
- **savage** – dated, offensive: uncivilized person
- **bleach** – strong chemical used to clean or colour things white
- **garment** – item of clothing
- **brassiere** – formal: bra

Page 8

- **enchanted** – magical
- **tinned** – BrE: preserved in a can
- **ravenous** – very hungry
- **steel toe cap** – piece of metal covering the front part of a boot
- **unwind** – (unwound, unwound) unwrap, unravel
- **back and fro** – repeatedly backward and forward

- **giddy** – dizzy, light-headed
- **strip light** – tube-shaped electric light usually fixed to the ceiling
- **captivity** – imprisonment, confinement
- **threadbare** – worn and shabby
- **halfling** – offensive: half-grown person
- **plantain** – type of banana used in African cooking
- **implore** – formal: beg, plead with
- **pluck (out)** – pull out, remove (hair, feather etc.)
- **defy** – refuse to obey, rebel against
- **slab** – thick flat piece of a hard material
- **off the grid** – AmE: living without basic services of electricity, water, gas etc.
- **flicker** – shine unsteadily
- **entwined** – twisted together
- **adorn** – decorate
- **intricate** – detailed, complex
- **stifling** – very hot and difficult to breathe
- **adobe** – building material made with sun-dried earth and straw
- **transient** – staying only for a short time
- **retiree** – AmE: retired person
- **snowbird** – AmE, informal: person who moves to a warmer climate in the winter
- **grifter** – AmE, informal: person who gets money dishonestly
- **squat** – occupy land or property illegally
- **digs** – informal: rented accommodation

Page 9

- **beat-up** – informal: old and in bad condition
- **stake out** – claim, mark out
- **makeshift** – temporary, improvised
- **sewage** – waste matter and dirty water from homes
- **disposal** – getting rid of something
- **scraggly** – AmE: thin and untidy
- **swig** – drink something in large mouthfuls
- **lithe** – able to move easily and gracefully
- **strum** – move your fingers up and down the strings of an instrument
- **nestle** – lie comfortably close
- **tattered** – old and torn
- **canvas** – cloth used to make tents, sails etc.
- **rock up** – informal: arrive unannounced
- **shaded** – protected from sunlight
- **tin** – a soft light silver metal, or a container made of this
- **ingenious** – very clever
- **resilience** – *here*: ability to keep going despite setbacks
- **rife** – very common, widespread
- **fill someone in (on)** – informal: provide someone with facts/information
- **prim** – behaving in a formal and correct way; easily shocked by anything rude
- **clipboard** – portable writing board

- **hassle** – informal: cause someone problems
- **reams** – informal: large quantity
- **host** – receive and look after guests
- **dirtbag** – informal: unpleasant and dishonest person
- **jaded** – bored and tired, no longer enthusiastic
- **anticipation** – expectation
- **lease** – rent out
- **drifter** – person who doesn't stay in one place for long
- **top off** – AmE: add to, complete
- **muse** – reflect, consider
- **on the spot** – immediately, there and then
- **lenient** – moderate, not severe
- **temptress** – literary: woman who tries to attract men sexually
- **imminent** – happening very soon
- **martial law** – when an army controls an area instead of its usual leaders
- **in succession** – in a row, one after the other
- **roving** – *here*: moving
- **picket** – group of soldiers that guard troops from a surprise attack
- **endeavour** – formal: try hard
- **ordnance** – weapons and ammunition
- **quartermaster** – officer responsible for providing soldiers with food, equipment and other necessities

Page 10

- **dispatch** – message, report
- **clipping** – article or picture cut from a newspaper
- **skedaddle** – informal: run off
- **provided** – on condition (that), only if
- **consequential** – formal: important
- **bonnet** – hat worn by a woman with ribbons tied under the chin
- **lurch** – move suddenly, jump
- **immaculate** – totally perfect
- **coax** – gently push, urge
- **foghorn** – device that makes a sound to warn ships in fog
- **shear** – cut (off)
- **preternatural** – formal: supernatural
- **limbs** – legs and arms
- **marvel** – be amazed
- **bound** – run or jump with large steps
- **agility** – ability to move quickly and easily
- **dash** – run quickly
- **approbation** – formal: approval, support
- **private** – low-ranking soldier
- **infantry** – (group of) foot soldiers
- **glide** – move effortlessly
- **ravine** – very narrow valley with steep sides

- **heed** – formal: notice, pay attention to
- **maiden** – archaic: unmarried girl/young woman
- **supple** – able to move and bend easily
- **dare** – have the courage to do something
- **raspy** – rough, hoarse
- **gust** – sudden rush of wind
- **dip** – slope, hollow
- **gratified** – formal: pleased
- **disastrous** – extremely bad
- **casualties** – people hurt or killed
- **hold court** – be the centre of attention among friends/admirers
- **afame** – literary: showing strong emotion; on fire
- **stoop** – bend forward and down
- **crimson** – deep red colour
- **crumpled** – crushed, creased
- **render** – formal: provide, give
- **inevitable** – impossible to avoid
- **bulrush** – BrE: tall plant that grows near water
- **ornamental** – decorative, for show
- **foray** – expedition, short journey
- **court** – disaster: risk something unpleasant
- **the converse** – formal: the opposite

Page 11

- **hold true** – remain true/valid
- **duress** – formal: threat, force
- **revel in** – enjoy very much
- **teem with** – be full of
- **ravine** – very narrow valley with steep sides
- **token** – formal: evidence, symbol
- **caked** – thickly covered
- **grain** – seed (here of wheat)
- **rend** – literary: tear (into pieces)
- **gonk** – trademark: egg-shaped doll with frizzy hair
- **bulge** – swell, stick out
- **corduroy** – thick material with raised lines
- **snuffle** – sniff or breathe noisily
- **refuse** – formal: rubbish
- **tattered** – torn, shabby
- **gawky** – nervously awkward, without grace
- **taut** – tense, firm
- **crotch** – area between the legs at the bottom of the torso
- **trim** – thin and healthy-looking
- **commute** – travel regularly to and from work
- **jaunt** – short trip (for fun)
- **gurgle** – make a bubbling sound

- **plash** – make a splashing sound
- **sheen** – soft shine
- **meander** – wind, snake
- **omnipresent** – formal: ever-present, everywhere
- **unkempt** – dirty and untidy
- **tangible** – formal: able to be touched; real, concrete
- **black out** – sudden loss of consciousness; when everything goes dark
- **tide** – rise and fall of the sea; wave(s)
- **chip away at** – gradually make something weaker
- **infatuated** – deeply in love
- **glimmer** – soft weak light
- **do one's utmost** – try as hard as you can
- **acutely** – extremely, intensely
- **inferiority** – state of not being (or not thinking you are) as good as others
- **aggravated** – severe, serious
- **aptitude** – natural skill/ability
- **psychology** – *here*: mental characteristics
- **clump** – *here*: walk noisily and heavily
- **magnify** – enlarge, make bigger

Page 12

- **full steam** – at full speed
- **starry(-eyed)** – dreamy, optimistic
- **eclipse** – overpower, overshadow
- **peal** – sound (of loud laughter or ringing bells)
- **menagerie** – collection of wild animals kept for show
- **cut the rug** – AmE, informal: dance
- **budge** – move
- **a blessing in disguise** – something bad that results in something good
- **jar** – *here*: shake
- **abashed** – embarrassed
- **husky** – low and rough (voice)
- **tumultuous** – literary: noisy and excited
- **stumblejohn** – clumsy person
- **gingerly** – carefully, cautiously
- **decorous** – formal: polite and controlled
- **perturbation** – formal: worry, uneasiness
- **make a clean breast of it** – tell the truth about something
- **have no call** – have no right/reason
- **gay** – *here, dated*: happy and lively
- **go steady** – informal, dated: be in a romantic relationship with someone
- **enrapt** – literary: caught up, enthralled
- **abate** – formal: become less strong
- **flop** – fall or drop heavily
- **snuff out** – put out (a flame)
- **desolation** – great sadness and emptiness

- **unsteadily** – *here*: shakily
- **pitcher** – AmE: jug
- **realm** – area of interest or activity
- **refute** – formal: reject, deny
- **escapism** – seeking entertainment or other pleasant experiences to forget about uninteresting/unpleasant aspects of life
- **graphic** – detailed, explicit (usually in a negative sense)
- **upside** – advantage
- **domain** – area, sphere
- **slaughter** – kill violently

Page 13

- **constitute** – formal: be; make up, amount to
- **fallacy** – false belief
- **at close quarters** – close by, (from) a short distance away
- **indistinct** – unclear
- **ambient** – existing/present all around you
- **flare** – a sudden burst; OR a shape that becomes wider at one end (e.g. the end of a trumpet or trombone)
- **keenly** – intensely, acutely
- **morph** – change into something else
- **percussive** – sounding like drum beats
- **serene** – peaceful, calm
- **oblivious** – not aware of or concerned about
- **stark** – extreme and obvious
- **swell** – *here*: gradual increase in sound
- **imply** – suggest something without saying it directly
- **otherness** – the quality or fact of being different
- **entail** – formal: mean, involve
- **anecdotally** – based on reports or observations by unscientific observers
- **colloquially** – in everyday language
- **ambiguity** – something that is unclear because it has different meanings
- **rousing** – exciting, stimulating
- **quest** – mission, aim; long difficult search
- **repress** – hold back, keep down
- **define** – describe, identify
- **diverge** – go in separate directions
- **undergrowth** – mass of small bushes or plants growing under trees
- **hence** – formal, *here*: from this time
- **fledgling** – recently formed, new
- **prevalent** – common, widespread
- **setting** – *here*: location, place
- **prolific** – productive, producing a lot
- **keenness** – enthusiasm, eagerness
- **showcase** – show the best qualities of something
- **give rise to** – create, lead to

- **transcendental** – relating to a spiritual life, not understood in ordinary ways
- **exert** – formal, *here*: apply, (put into) use
- **convey** – communicate, express
- **disillusionment** – disappointment, cynicism
- **foresee** – (foresaw, foreseen) predict, expect
- **gloomy** – miserable, depressing

Page 14

- **peer** – *here*: person with the same rank, social standing, abilities etc.
- **perception** – the way we understand or think about something
- **unify** – combine, join
- **indistinguishable** – identical, impossible to tell apart
- **crockery** – cups, plates, bowls etc. often made of china
- **entropy** – a lack of order in a system
- **intact** – complete, not broken
- **readily** – freely, easily
- **expand** – increase, become larger
- **evolve** – gradually change and develop
- **make a killing** – informal: make a lot of money very quickly
- **imply** – (strongly) suggest
- **decay** – decompose, crumble

Page 15

- **recurring** – happening again and again
- **apparition** – formal: vision
- **seep** – leak, gradually spread
- **disconsolate** – hopelessly unhappy
- **utility pole** – tall wooden pole used to support telephone and electrical wires
- **garish** – bright and colourful in an ugly way; gaudy
- **contingency** – emergency, something (bad) that might happen in the future
- **graph** – chart, diagram
- **tentative** – hesitant, not confident
- **weighted** – biased
- **offspring** – child, baby; *here*: product, result
- **eddy** – fast circular movement; whirl, vortex
- **intercept** – cross, interrupt
- **indulgent** – kind, tolerant
- **eccentricity** – unconventional behaviour, oddness
- **eminently** – formal: highly, extremely
- **impending** – imminent, happening very soon
- **bulk** – large mass/shape; majority
- **sloping** – slanted, inclined
- **steel oneself** – mentally prepare oneself to do something difficult
- **haze** – mist, fog

- **discernible** – able to be seen, visible
- **bifurcate** – formal: divide into two separate parts; fork
- **jab** – prod, poke
- **incongruous** – formal: odd, not in harmony with surroundings
- **subsequent** – formal: following, later
- **astounded** – astonished, very surprised
- **stagger** – stumble, walk unsteadily
- **demarcation** – formal: limit, boundary
- **foreboding** – ominous feeling, sense that something bad is going to happen
- **munch** – chew noisily
-